Ashes of the Walls: Storyline, Roles and the Rumbling

Working title. Companion to the Game Design & Architecture Blueprint. Faithful, dark, tragic and difficult.

1. Name Options

Name	Feel
Ashes of the Walls (recommended)	Tragic, mature, hints at the fall and the Rumbling
Wings of Ruin	Sharp and dramatic, evokes ODM and loss
Children of the Walls	Emotional, fits the "you grow up" pillar
The Last Wall	Short and strong, works as a logo
Rumbling Dawn	Action-forward, but spoils the ending

Tagline idea: *"You were born behind the walls. You will die for what lies beyond them."*

2. The Player

Creation

- Name, gender, face, hair, build, scar and skin options.
- Starting district: **Shiganshina** (the story begins there).
- **Bloodline** (permanent, chosen at creation):

- **Common Eldian:** balanced, no penalties, best for first playthrough.

- **Ackerman-blooded (rare):** later awakening grants a huge speed and strength burst, but you carry heavier trauma and stress.

- **Scholar's child:** slower start in combat, but unlocks research, tactics and the highest Command potential.

- **Origin B (later content):** start as an Eldian child in the Liberio internment zone in Marley instead. Same war, other side of the sea.

The Anchor

The game gives you one original character, **your Anchor** (a sibling, parent figure or closest friend you pick at the start). They are your emotional core. The Anchor's fate depends on your choices, and it is meant to hurt.

3. Roles and Ranks

The player advances by **merit, trust and surviving**. Rank unlocks missions, squad control and story access.

Path	Ladder	Highest role you can reach
Survey Corps	Recruit, Soldier, Squad Member, Squad Leader, Captain, Division Commander	**Commander of the Survey Corps / Field Commander of the Alliance** in the finale
Garrison Regiment	Recruit, Soldier, Team Leader, Captain, Division Commander	**Garrison Commander** (Wall defense authority)
Military Police	Recruit, Officer, Squad Leader, Captain, Brigade Commander	**Military Police Brigade Commander** (control of the capital)
Special track: Anti-Titan Specialist	Unlocked by high kill count and Ackerman bloodline	**Elite Strike Captain** (leads the best squad in the game)

Important: canon characters hold the top posts at certain times. In the game those posts **open up when canon holders fall or step aside**, so you only reach them if you earned trust and the story reaches that point. You always have a **Division-level command** to lead your own squad.

Top-tier endgame roles:

- Alliance Field Commander (leads the final battle plan).
- Elite Strike Captain (spearhead against the Colossal Titans).
- Flight Wing Leader (aerial assault squad in the final battle).

4. The Full Storyline

Each Act maps to the blueprint's chapters. **Canon events always happen**; your role, survival and relationships change.

Prologue: Shiganshina (Year 845, age 8 to 10)

- Walk-around life in Shiganshina: your Anchor, neighbors, market, the canal, the wall gate, drunk Garrison soldiers, the children who dream of the outside.
- **The Breach:** the Colossal Titan appears, the gate shatters, the Armored Titan breaks through. Chaos, rubble and fleeing crowds.
- Escape sequence (first playable action beat, no ODM yet): run, climb, hide, reach the boats.
- **Tragic hook:** your Anchor's fate is decided here by your choices. You will carry the result for the rest of the game.

Act 1: Refugee Years (845 to 847)

- Starvation, labor and rumor in the Wall Rose interior. Tension between survivors and locals.
- **The retaking of Wall Maria:** a brutal, morally gray order is carried out on the refugees. You witness the cost and feel the cruelty of the government.
- Choice at the end: **enlist** in the Training Corps. This choice cannot be skipped, but your reason (revenge, duty, survival, hope) colors dialogue for the rest of the game.

Act 2: The Training Corps (847 to 850)

- Training grounds under a ruthless instructor. Meet the cadets: the angry boy, the quiet girl with the red scarf, the genius, the loud rival, the potato girl, the cheerful one, and others.
- Mini-games: balance gear, ODM course, hand-to-hand, horse riding, written exams.
- **Rankings:** the top ten may join the Military Police. Your ranking changes who you meet.
- **Graduation:** pick your branch (Garrison, Military Police or Survey Corps). The Survey Corps choice is the dangerous one and the one the story favors.

Act 3: The Fall of Trost (850)

- The Colossal Titan returns. The gate breaks again.
- Your first real battle: ODM combat in a ruined district, limited gas, panicking squad.
- Training-corps friends die, including someone the player may have grown close to.
- **A shifter appears in the chaos:** a Titan that attacks other Titans.
- Operation to plug the gate: your role depends on your branch (distraction, escort, supply run, or ground fighting).

Act 4: The 57th Expedition (850)

- Beyond the walls: formation, flares, horses, a long journey.
- **The Female Titan** hunts the formation. A tense forest chase in the Forest of Giant Trees where flanks collapse one by one.
- Elite squad deaths. The player witnesses heartbreaking losses and may lose a key friend.
- Survivors retreat with heavy casualties. Rank and morale shift.

Act 5: Stohess and the Capture (850)

- Urban chase through Stohess rooftops and alleys.
- The Female Titan fight inside the city, with huge collateral damage.
- **The reveal** of who she is, and the capture. The player is part of the trap or the pursuit.
- Political fallout: the government wants to take control.

Act 6: Utgard and the Uprising (850)

- **Utgard:** a ruined fortress and a terrifying revelation about the Titans' origin and the traitors among the cadets.
- **The Coup:** the Military Police and Survey Corps clash over the royal family. Your branch puts you on a different side of the fight.
- **Reiss Chapel:** a final bloody confrontation and a massive Titan.
- The throne changes hands and the Survey Corps gains power.

Act 7: Return to Shiganshina (850)

- A desperate plan to retake the home district and reach the basement.
- **The cost:** a famous leader sacrifices himself and his veterans to buy the moment you need. You are there.
- The Beast and Armored Titans fight back. Gas runs low, blades break and friends die.
- **Inheritance of the Colossal:** one comrade is chosen to survive, one is lost.
- The basement reveals the truth about the world and the ocean.

Time Skip (850 to 854)

- Playable downtime: scouting, island politics, exploring the sea and the world beyond the walls.
- Skill trees and gear tier-ups. A new generation of recruits appears.

Act 8: The War for Marley (854)

- Marley is shown from the inside: military power, Eldian prisoners and warriors.
- A sneak infiltration of Liberio and a festival that turns into an attack.
- **The declaration of war:** the first strike changes everything.
- Optional **Origin B** players start here instead of at the walls.

Act 9: The Island at War (854 to 855)

- Back on Paradis, the island is split. A rebellion grows, led by a radical faction (the Yeagerists), against the old regime.
- Old friends choose different sides. You must choose too: **Alliance** (stop the madness) or **Yeagerists** (support the radical plan).
- Betrayals and sacrifices. The player may lose their Anchor for good here depending on earlier choices.

Act 10: The Rumbling (855)

This is the climax of the game, built as a multi-stage final act.

Phase 1: The Awakening. The Founding power is used. The walls' colossal giants awaken and begin marching.

Phase 2: The March. The player sees the Rumbling from the ground: a wall of steam, an ocean of massive Titans crushing everything. Early missions focus on survival and evacuation, then escalation.

Phase 3: The Alliance. Former enemies unite. Your role depends on your path:

- **Field Commander** (Survey Corps top path): plan and direct the battle in real time (squad orders, timing, sacrifices).
- **Strike Captain** (Elite track): lead the ground assault against the Colossal Titans.
- **Wing Leader** (Flight track): command the flying strike force.
- **Defender** (Garrison): hold the last evacuation points.
- **Civil Guard** (Military Police): control civilian evacuation and prevent panic.

Phase 4: The Battle of Heaven and Earth. A massive set-piece battle: giant Titans, ODM squads, Jaw and Cart style shifters, aerial assaults, gas and ammo shortages, constant losses.

Phase 5: The Last Confrontation. The final fight takes place at the origin of the Titans. The result depends on the player's trust, kills, relationships and decisions across the game.

Epilogue

Depends on the ending reached (section 5). Possible final cutscenes include the aftermath, a memorial, and a quiet closing scene with the player's Anchor or their memory.

5. Endings

Ending	How you reach it
The Long Peace (best)	High trust with key allies, Anchor alive, Alliance plan succeeds with minimal losses
The Cost	The Rumbling is stopped, but many allies and your Anchor are lost
Ashes	The plan only half succeeds, the world is scarred, and the player survives alone
The Yeagerist Road	You side with the radical plan and live in the new world, with consequences
Fallen Wings	The player dies in the final battle, with a legacy cutscene

6. Making It Hard and Keeping You Playing

Difficulty

- **Scarce resources:** limited gas and blades per mission, no free refills mid-fight.
- **Real consequences:** injuries linger, squad members can die permanently.
- **Smart Titans:** abnormals behave unpredictably, and boss fights need learning.
- **Difficulty modes:** Cadet, Soldier (default), Veteran (permadeath for named allies), Legend (one life per chapter).

Replay loop

- **Daily Missions:** short ODM challenges, Titan hunts and training trials.
- **Branching paths:** three branches plus Origin B give many full playthroughs.

- **Rank leaderboards and challenge runs:** speed kills, no-damage runs, score attack.
- **Titan Hunt mode:** endless survival with rising difficulty.
- **Collectibles and lore:** journals, memorials, hidden scenes, character bond stories.
- **Customization:** uniforms, capes, blade skins, gas tank designs.

7. Build Order for the Story

1. **M0 to M1:** ODM and combat prototype using a test arena.
2. **M2:** Prologue (Shiganshina and the Breach).
3. **M3:** Act 1 and Act 2 (refugees, training).
4. **M4:** Act 3 (Trost).
5. **M5:** Acts 4 and 5 (expedition, Stohess).
6. **M6 onward:** Acts 6 to 10, one at a time, with the Rumbling built last and polished most.

8. Notes on Your Existing Models

- Three.js can load **GLB/GLTF and FBX directly**, so we do not need to convert files to start.
- GitHub's browser upload limit is about **25 MB per file**. Larger files must be compressed or split.
- Official character models are copyrighted. If they came from game or anime rips, keep the repo **private while prototyping** and plan to swap in original-look characters before any public release.
- Maps are limited, so we will build modular kits (walls, rooftops, streets) and reuse them across districts.